

Mr. Bachchan had this to say on the occasion, "The energy I see today and the happiness with which all of you have greeted me has overwhelmed me. I have read up and have known about IDFC FIRST Bank, I'm extremely proud to be associated with this prestigious bank. The single-most reason I love IDFC FIRST Bank is because it has been founded on great values and great ethics. This is what the country needs. The Bank is transforming the lives of a large population of our country with new-age products and services. It is my great pleasure to be the brand ambassador of IDFC FIRST Bank."

At IDFC FIRST Bank, the vision statement of our bank is, "To build a world-class bank in India, guided by ethics, powered by technology, and to be a force for social good". We thought hard about every word in this vision statement. We take each one of these words seriously. We believe, to build a world class bank in India, is one of the greatest privileges of our lifetime and we are making efforts day and night to make this happen. The foundation has been laid and we are improving by the day. We are determined to build a bank India will be proud of.

Everything we build at IDFC FIRST Bank, we always think of building for the long run. We take no shortcuts. We have taken three years building the foundation of our bank with a strong deposit base, among the highest CASA in the industry at 50% +. We have a high-quality loan book seasoned for over a decade, and we have great corporate governance. Whatever the challenges, we took them head on and dealt with them fairly and squarely.

In terms of culture, we say this to our employees "We have one constituency to please - the customer. Go all out and make them happy. If we do this well, all other constituencies will be happy with us". We are a new bank and we have embedded the 'customer-friendly' ethos in our DNA. In this direction, we became the first universal bank in the country that began crediting interest on savings accounts to our customers on a 'monthly basis'. We decided not to charge premature FD breakage charges for senior citizens. We don't charge fees for 'non-home-branch' transactions. We don't charge for cash transactions at the branch, NEFT charges, RTGS charges, IMPS charges, Chequebook issuance charges, ECS return charges, stop payment charges, standing instructions charges, and a whole host of charges, which are normal banking charges. The list is long and keeps our customers happy.

India has had credit cards for 30 years. Yet when we launched credit cards, we found so many specials to give our customers - we offered low interest rates starting at 9% for revolving - carry over facility, based on credit scores and other criteria. Truly caring for our customers, we started a practice of reminding customers of due dates and over-limit ahead of time, so that customers don't get charged fees for inadvertent mistakes. So, we gave away this source of income in the interest of customer friendliness. We made our rewards points 'evergreen', so no one misses on the entitlements. We introduced the concept of 'zero joining fee and zero annual fees' without any minimum spend conditions. We introduced the concept of letting customers redeem their rewards points against their next online purchase. All these customer-friendly concepts reflect our approach to our customers. We tell our employees to only design such products which we can sell to our nearest and dearest family members. We call it the 'Near-Dear' test. Once our customers experience our products and services, they see the spirit of our conduct, they then stick with us and spread the good word about us.





Back to Mr Bachchan, we are delighted to have such an iconic personality, the superstar of the millennium, as our brand ambassador. His appeal cuts across all ages and generations, in cities, towns and villages, domestically and internationally. He is a great ambassador not just for us but for our beloved country and for our millions. On behalf of all of us, I wish him a very happy 80th Birthday.

V Vaidyanathan
MD & CEO
IDFC FIRST Bank